

of money I now earn in one year makes me realize how much money I actually lost by starting 3 years late. The habit of always putting off something until you can afford it, or until the time is right, or until you know how to do it is one of the greatest thieves of joy.

As they say, *"If and When were planted, and Nothing grew."*

Once you have made up your mind – jump in.

Keep your partner informed

Nothing can be more emotionally traumatic than the loss of a dear one. It can have some financial repercussions if the deceased person had handled most of the household investments. But it can be a financially crippling nightmare if he or she never told anyone else about these investments or never left any records.

People are disorganized about their finances because they never think something will happen to them.

Lack of information and lack of interest in financial matters have been the two biggest reasons behind poor investment decisions. Now lack of communication is emerging as another key cause. Most people do not communicate their financial decisions to family members because of oversight or procrastination. Strangely, individualism too is creeping into personal finances these days and couples are steadfastly refusing to share financial information with each other.

It pays if your family, in the event of any such tragedy, is aware of all your investments and records. All your hard work through your living days should not go to complete waste just because you did not find the time to share the financial details with your loved ones.

Remember that your family will be contributing equally, if not more, to help you succeed in this beautiful journey towards financial freedom. They deserve to know about every single investment.

I personally gave a detailed briefing of all my financial investments and my future plans to my spouse only when I was just 2 years away from my